Sadat convened the National Security Council and informed its members of his decision to violate the cease-fire in the near future, explaining that this was now the most opportune time to do so from a political point of view. On September 30, Sadat convened the Supreme War Council and conveyed a similar message to its members, again without specifying the precise date. On October 2, just four days before the date set for the start of the war, Sadat relayed the date of October 6 to his minister of war, Ahmed Ismail, and ordered him to update the representatives of the Syrian general staff in Cairo and to fly to Damascus the following day for further coordination.

Sadat's Goals and General Outline for the War

Sadat's strategic goal beginning with his rise to power in 1970 was and remained the extrication of the conflict from its stagnation by means of a military operation that would lead to a diplomatic process. The detailed war plans progressed and matured toward the end of 1973, and symmetry evolved between the general methods outlined in the Egyptian and the Syrian war plans. They both intended to open with air strikes and artillery fire. This would be followed by the infiltration of infantry divisions (five Egyptian and three Syrian) to secure a bridgehead (ten to fifteen kilometers in Sinai and six to eight kilometers in the Golan Heights). Assuming that the securing of the bridgeheads was successfully completed, the armored divisions would advance through them, in the Egyptian case, to the Mitla and Gidi crossings. The war plans mentioned two stages, without specifying a precise timetable between the first and second stages. On the eve of the war, in the complete report from the meeting that was received on the morning of October 6, it was stated that the first stage was intended to capture a strip ten kilometers east of the Canal and that the effort to move eastward into Sinai would be decided on the basis of the results of the first stage; that is, for the first time there was an element of interlude added between the two stages.

Military Buildup and Closing Gaps in Preparation for War

In 1972 and 1973, the Mossad provided hundreds of intelligence reports from its best sources on Egypt's and Syria's armament and on the closing of the gaps that were defined as a condition for going to war. These reports came from HUMINT sources (agents) and friendly intelligence services.